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IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE SECOND JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR LEON COUNTY, FLORIDA

2025 CA 002469

CASE NO.: [To Be Assigned]

(IN RE) CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children \[8 years old] and \[6 years old],

Petitioner,

v.

THE FLORIDA BAR, RICHARD COURTEMANCHE, ALLIE HUSTON, and ALICIA GANGI

Respondents.

VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

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Petitioner Christopher Hanson, as attorney for himself and next friend and attorney for his minor children, files this Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees and Costs against The Florida Bar and its named officers/representatives, pursuant to Article V, Section 5(b) of the Florida Constitution, compelling Respondents to comply with their clear legal duties under the Florida Constitution and the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, including but not limited to Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, by providing engagement, transparency and access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 against attorney Scott Paul Davis (RFA No. 25-6861), which among other relief requested, should be reopened for a proper investigation and discipline to deter further misconduct in the cases discussed herein, and for all future litigants in Florida.

1. Petitioner requests relief under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch records, declaratory intervention, and relief under common law, the constitution and in equity.

2. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Petitioner), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e).

3. Petitioner also seeks mandamus and/or declaratory relief relating to failures in handling the unrefuted violations described in the Davis complaint (Appendix, Item 5, pp. 40-64), conflicts of interest within the Florida Bar relating to additional disciplinary matters concerning Petitioner, Judge Ayers, and additional members and representatives of the Florida Bar.

I. Jurisdiction

4. This Court has original jurisdiction to issue writs of mandamus directing The Florida Bar and the other defendants in the performance of its regulatory functions, as the Bar operates under the Court's authority. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (empowering circuit courts to issue writs of mandamus); Art. V, § 15, Fla. Const., R. Regulating Fla. Bar 1-12.1.; see also The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741 (Fla. 2005) (confirming the judiciary's supervisory authority over Bar disciplinary records and processes under Rule 3-7.1).

5. This Court also has jurisdiction over declaratory relief pursuant to Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, which empowers circuit courts to declare rights, status, and other equitable or legal relations, including in cases involving constitutional rights and administrative actions. See §86.011, Fla. Stat.

6. Additionally, this Court possesses inherent equitable jurisdiction to grant relief in equity, including injunctions and other remedies to prevent irreparable harm from ongoing

violations of constitutional and regulatory duties. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (granting circuit courts broad equity powers).

7. Venue is proper in Leon County as the principal place of business for The Florida Bar and the location where the cause of action accrued. See §47.011, Fla. Stat.; The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (actions against the Bar typically venued in Leon County).

II. Introduction and Parties

8. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a).

9. This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).

10. Petitioner Christopher Hanson is a resident of Hillsborough County, Florida, and a member of The Florida Bar.

11. He is the complainant in the underlying Bar matter and has standing as the requester of public records under Article I, Section 24, Florida Constitution, and Rule 2.420, as the complainant in the bar complaint against Davis, and as the Respondent in Ayers' complaint

against him, with certain rights including "engagement" with the Bar in the investigation process.

12. As next friend for his minor children, he asserts their interests in records impacting their welfare in the family law case.

13. Respondent The Florida Bar is the custodian of the records at issue, operating as an arm of the judicial branch under Article V, Section 15, Florida Constitution.

14. Respondents Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi are Bar officers or representatives involved in the handling, investigation, and/or denial of access to the requested records and information.

15. Petitioner seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of records unlawfully withheld by The Florida Bar and its officers, answers to basic questions that went unanswered due to the bar's failing to "engage" with petitioner (in violation of their own rules), and corrective actions for failures in accountability and damage to public confidence in the judiciary these facts have produced to date.

16. These requests, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to attorney misconduct and the Bar's handling of a complaint against Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284, RFA No. 25-6861). Appendix Items 1 and 2, p. 1-36).

III. Factual Background

A. Davis's Misconduct and Concealment of Financial Evidence

17. The facts surrounding the bar complaint against Davis demonstrate Judicial bias and systemic corruption dominating the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and the

JQC's handling of Petitioner's complaint on Judge Ayers. (Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205).

18. The ministerial duties the Florida Bar shirked, necessitating this petition/complaint, relate to Davis's and Ayers' misconduct in concealing/suppressing clearly discoverable financial evidence at the core of the parties' dispute as Petitioner explained in his initial filing back in May of 2024.

19. The concealment and suppression of discoverable financial records violated Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.280(b) and ethical obligations under Rule 4-3.4(c) to obey discovery rules. See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275 (Writ for Certiorari detailing Judge Ayers' suppression of financial evidence central to equitable distribution); Appendix Item 18, pp. 276–281 (See also Item 19, pp. 282-285, Initial pleading emphasizing urgency of financial discovery).

B. Instead of Addressing Davis's Ethical Violations, Ayers Actively Assists with Suppression.

20. Judge Ayers "fixed" the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) by repeatedly excusing Davis's misconduct while suppressing efforts to obtain financial discovery, the only reason for any litigation between the parties.

21. These actions contravened Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, requiring judges to accord full right to be heard and dispose promptly of proceedings. See Appendix Item 16, pp. 202–243 (Initial brief challenging venue denial and systemic bias).

22. This suppression enabled Davis's tactics of child weaponization—using the children as leverage through unfounded allegations and prolonged litigation—causing ongoing emotional harm to the minor children and delaying resolution for over a year. See Canon 3B(7), Fla. Code Jud. Conduct and Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275.

23. The initial misconduct involving Davis and then Ayers' refusal to address it triggered a massive cover-up that now encompasses the 13th Judicial Circuit (through withheld records and venue trapping), the Florida Bar (via non-investigation of Davis and advancement of Ayers' retaliatory complaint), and the JQC (via summary dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Ayers without inquiry).

24. This systemic protectionism prioritizes insiders over public accountability, perpetuating the harm to Petitioner's family and eroding judicial integrity. Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (emphasizing impartiality in disciplinary processes to avoid due process violations); See Appendix Items 16–19, pp. 202–285 (collective evidence of systemic failures, retaliatory complaints, and concealment of core records).Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (JQC complaint against Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts and lack of transparency); Appendix Item 10, pp. 97-119 (Ayers' retaliatory Bar complaint as evidence of abuse of process).

C. The Florida Bar Violates its Own Rules in Protecting Davis (and Ayers) from Accountability for their Misconduct:

25. The Florida Bar's intentional lack of transparency and refusal to engage, even in direct violation of Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, have directly harmed petitioner and his family with no legitimate state interest served.

26. The only apparent motive for the refusal to engage and continuing concealment of materials exchanged with Davis from the partial production of documents (on November 10, 2025) is to cover for insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.

27. The unrefuted and irrefutable nature of Davis's misconduct make it impossible for anyone to actually excuse or justify his (Ayers's and others') actions, so silence and concealment are the only ways to accomplish their unwavering goal to protect insiders.

28. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003).

29. Here, as in any case where evidence points to broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism at the expense of litigants and the public in general, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given the Bar's role in regulating the legal profession and citizens' access to justice. Id.

30. In a "lawyers policing lawyers" system like The Florida Bar's self-regulatory framework, transparency is a constitutional mandate, a safeguard against inherent conflicts and potential corruption.

31. The public interest demands heightened access to records where, as here, there are allegations of broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism, enabling unchecked judicial and attorney misconduct. See The Fla. Bar v. Davis, 661 So. 2d 1193, 1197 (Fla. 1995) (noting that public confidence in judicial integrity erodes when corruption is perceived, emphasizing the need for transparency to maintain trust).

32. On February 18, 2025, Petitioner filed a detailed complaint with The Florida Bar against Attorney Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284) for still unrefuted ethical violations in family law case 24-DR-001150, including delays, harassment, concealment, and child weaponization tactics. (Appendix Item 5, pp. 40-64.)

33. Despite repeated good-faith efforts to engage—documented in a 25-page email chain spanning February to November 2025—the Bar provided form acknowledgments to a fraction of his efforts and no meaningful investigation, interview, nor interest in the additional evidence and clarification offered. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)

34. The complaint was improperly dismissed without probable cause, exonerating Davis despite substantiated allegations. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65.) To date, Davis has never disputed any of the specific facts alleged in the complaint despite many opportunities in pleadings, correspondence, and in open Court.

35. Petitioner sought closed file reviews and appeals, but the Bar's opacity and refusals to engage persisted. (Appendix Items 3-4, pp. 37-39.)

D. The Florida Bar Continues to Protect Insiders from Accountability as it Refuses to Comply with Constitutionally Mandated Transparency:

36. On November 10, 2025, in response to public records request W015656-111025, the Bar provided incomplete records, omitting substantive communications with Davis except a typographical error email. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)

37. Petitioner's December 1, 2025, follow-up narrowed the inquiry to four specific questions about Davis communications, privilege claims, and a confidentiality index, but received no response. (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11.)

38. Petitioner's detailed follow up from December 15, 2025 received only further disinterest, stating, "This matter is closed."

39. This non-responsiveness mirrors the Bar's pattern since February 2025, including failures under Rule 3-7.3(c) (preliminary investigation) and Rule 3-7.1(b) (public records - concealment of rebuttal materials and correspondence with Davis).

40. The Bar's handling contrasts sharply with its advancement of a vague, retaliatory complaint against Petitioner by Judge Kelly Ayers (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)), requiring Petitioner's formal response while potentially excusing Davis entirely. (Appendix Items 9-12, pp. 96-127.)

41. The withheld records are essential to ensuring accountability for misconduct, restoring fairness in the family law case, and rehabilitating confidence in the judiciary.

E. The Florida Bar fails to meet its Burden in Justifying the Refusals to Engage and Comply with Constitutional Transparency

42. The Bar has never offered any explanation nor any rebuttal materials for its decision to dismiss the bar complaint beyond the absurd idea that it was deferring the disciplinary issues to co-conspirator (also guilty of severe misconduct), Ayers.

43. No exemptions apply in that the Florida Bar has still not even disclosed whether rebuttal materials exist nor what correspondence with Davis was ever sent or received.

44. Per The Florida Bar, "the matter is closed" making the records public under Rule 3-7.1(b), which expressly defines "public record" to include "any reports, correspondence, papers, and other materials furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent." See R.

Regulating Fla. Bar 3-7.1(b) (emphasizing that closed cases without probable cause become public records); see also The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (interpreting Rule 3-7.1 to require public access absent valid confidentiality exemptions).

45. Specifically, the Florida Bar continues to conceal records, correspondence, and other materials sent to or received from Attorney Davis fall squarely within this definition, while refusing to answer basic questions. (Appendix Items 1, 16, pp. 1-11, 202-205).

46. The Bar refuses even to confirm whether a response or rebuttal materials were ever submitted by Davis, a position that defies the plain language of Rule 3-7.1 and undermines the constitutional presumption of openness articulated in Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).

47. The burden is on the custodian to justify its refusal to engage with Petitioner on the Bar Complaint and any claimed exemptions from .

48. These refusals to engage, answer the simple questions and/or provide a privilege log are directly contrary to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

49. Such secrecy erodes public confidence and makes judicial intervention imperative.

IV. Conflicts of Interest and Systemic Corruption

50. The Bar's conduct underscores systemic conflicts of interest.

51. Its refusal to investigate substantiated and unrefuted allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis parallels the retaliatory complaint advanced by Judge Kelly Ayers against Petitioner—a complaint filed as File No. 2026-10,395(13F) and advanced by the Bar despite its vague

and unsupported (even unnamed) allegations. (Appendix Items 9-10, pp. 96-119; see also Appendix Item 11, pp. 120-122 (Petitioner's response to retaliatory complaint).)

52. At the same time, the Bar dismissed the Davis complaint without requiring Mr. Davis to offer any alternative explanation for the severe and intentional pattern of ethical violations outlined in Petitioner's Bar complaint. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65)

53. This selective enforcement and use of the Bar to protect insiders and attack those who demand accountability violates due process and expands corruption in the judicial system. See Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (discussing the importance of impartiality in Bar disciplinary processes to avoid due process concerns); see also The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556, 559 (Fla. 2001) (emphasizing fair application of disciplinary rules to maintain public trust).

54. This disparity and the continuing refusals to comply with constitutionally mandated transparency confirms the institutional bias favoring judicial insiders over complainants, warranting mandamus to address the absurdity and restore equity. (See Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (related JQC complaint against Judge Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts)).

55. The underlying family law misconduct ongoing for more than a year exemplifies the harm to litigants that including judicial bias in case 24-DR-001150, further compounds these issues. (Appendix Items 17, 18, pp. 206-275).

56. Petitioner's motion to disqualify Judge Ayers details patterns of favoritism and non-transparency that the Bar and JQC ignored. (Appendix Item 7, pp. 66-78.)

57. The Bar's non-engagement perpetuates this cycle, as evidenced in ongoing appellate motions challenging systemic failures. (Appendix Item 13, pp. 129-141.)

58. Such conduct not only harms Petitioner's family but undermines the Bar's regulatory integrity.

V. Legal Arguments for Mandamus and Relief

A. Mandamus to Compel Record Production and Reopen the Bar Complaint for Proper Handling Consistent with the Facts and Law described Herein:

59. A petitioner seeking a writ of mandamus must establish three key elements: (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief; (2) that the respondent has an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested action, which must be ministerial rather than discretionary; and (3) the absence of any other adequate legal remedy.

i. Clear legal right:

60. Petitioner has a clear legal right to the requested relief, including full access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 and the reopening of the investigation into attorney Scott Paul Davis's misconduct, as guaranteed by Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which mandates public access to judicial branch records, and by Rule 3-7.1 of the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, which defines such correspondence and reports as part of the public record absent justified exemptions—which none exist here. See The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (mandamus appropriate to enforce access to Bar records under Rule 3-7.1 where confidentiality not established).

61. The Bar's Failure to Engage and Provide Transparency Under Rule 3-7.1: Rule 3-7.1(b) defines "public record" broadly to include "any reports, correspondence, papers ... furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent."

62. Petitioner has repeatedly requested confirmation of communications with Mr. Davis beyond a minor typo email, yet the Bar refuses to disclose or even index such materials, claiming privilege in direct conflict with Rule 3-7.1(b). (Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36.)

63. This opacity violates the Bar's mandate for constitutional transparency, as Florida's constitution and due process require access to records impacting private rights.

64. The Bar's position—that only a judicial finding of misconduct triggers action—creates an absurd barrier when the judge (Ayers) is implicated, enabling systemic evasion to the great detriment of citizens and their confidence in the judicial system.

ii. Indubitable Legal Duty (Ministerial, Not Discretionary)

65. Respondents, including The Florida Bar and its officers Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi, have an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested actions, which are ministerial in nature—such as providing access to non-confidential records under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and conducting a proper preliminary investigation under Rule 3-7.3(c)—as these duties involve no discretion but rather mandatory compliance with established rules to ensure transparency and accountability in attorney discipline (see Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing unaddressed violations).

66. To rehabilitate confidence in these institutions, the Bar must immediately produce: · All communications with Mr. Davis or his representatives; (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11

(unanswered questions on these communications)) or a sworn affidavit confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege/confidentiality index for any withheld items;
- Confirmation of searches, including personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives who worked on the case; and
- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched to ensure compliance and transparency.
- Sworn statements from defendants described further below.

67. Accordingly, mandamus and/or declaratory relief is necessary to require the Bar to reopen the complaint against Mr. Scott Davis and perform a proper investigation with the engagement required by the rules. See Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 826 So. 2d 265, 267 (Fla. 2002) (entertaining mandamus petition to compel Bar to reopen disciplinary investigation where initial closure was inadequate); see also Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917, 919 (Fla. 2008) (affirming court's authority to review Bar actions via mandamus for failure to fulfill duties).

68. As part of the order, necessary to ensure accountability and protect the public, Petitioner requests the Court appoint an independent counsel and/or tribunal to oversee the investigation into the Davis complaint.

69. The Court's authority to compel reopening of a disciplinary matter arises from its inherent supervisory power over The Florida Bar under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution.

70. Independent oversight is imperative given the levels of insider protectionism and systemic corruption at the expense of litigants.

iii. No Other Adequate Remedy at Law

71. Petitioner has no other adequate remedy at law, as informal requests for records and engagement have been ignored or denied despite months of documented efforts (as evidenced by the email correspondence in Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36), and administrative appeals within The Florida Bar are unavailable or ineffective given the systemic issues alleged, leaving mandamus as the only means to compel compliance and prevent irreparable harm to public confidence in the judicial system.

72. Without this writ, the Bar's ongoing failures will continue to perpetuate unchecked attorney misconduct, further eroding trust in Florida's legal institutions and causing direct, ongoing harm to Petitioner, his minor children, and other litigants similarly situated, with no alternative forum or process capable of providing timely and complete relief.

B. Declaratory Relief:

73. Petitioner seeks a declaration that Respondents' withholding violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, Rule 3-7.1, and Rule 2.420, as the records are public and no valid exemption justifies secrecy.

74. This pattern—advancing a retaliatory complaint from Judge Ayers while dismissing substantiated allegations against Davis—demonstrates selective enforcement and institutional self-preservation.

75. This further justifies declaratory relief including payment of petitioner's attorney's fees and costs to enforce constitutional transparency and deter future misconduct.

76. Florida courts have emphasized that transparency is essential to maintain trust in judicial and quasi-judicial bodies. See Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (presumption of openness places burden on custodian to justify confidentiality); Florida Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (truth as defense to criticism; supports exposure of misconduct).

77. Given the Bar's refusal to engage with the complainant and its failure to justify dismissal, declaratory relief is necessary to enforce constitutional mandates and deter future misconduct.

78. Petitioner further seeks a declaration that Respondents' advancement of a retaliatory complaint against Petitioner while simultaneously ignoring substantiated allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis constitutes an abuse of process and violates Petitioner's due process rights under the Florida and United States Constitutions.

79. Such selective enforcement and systemic bias undermine public confidence in the integrity of the disciplinary system and warrant judicial intervention to prevent further harm and restore fairness. See Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 446 (2015) (highlighting due process implications in uneven Bar enforcement).

C. Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm

80. The obstacles the 13th Circuit and the Florida Bar have created to avoid transparency and having to explain their excusal of such obvious and intentional misconduct would be determinative for most litigants; they would simply never have access to justice. (See

Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184, referencing the article "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse" Link: https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20.)

81. Even more concerning, the obstacles to engagement and transparency would forever bury the misconduct David and Ayers committed in these facts for over a year.

82. Petitioner is in a unique position in that his many years of litigation experience allowed him to notice and document these almost unbelievably obvious and severe violations of the ethical rules for over a year; as pointed out in the article, "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse," this is the perfect storm to bring accountability to those guilty of ethical violations including those at the Florida Bar who violated their own rules, in part of the attempted cover-up. (See Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184).

83. These obstacles to transparency and refusals to engage cause significant delays and damages during times that are inherently difficult and stressful; perpetuating systemic issues like insider protectionism and avoiding transparency mandates places future litigants, who rely on the Bar to uphold ethical standards under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution, at increased risk of harm. (See Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205, evidencing unaddressed misconduct in the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and related complaints.)

84. The facts of this case are likely not unique, raising concern over how many families Ayers' and Davis's misconduct unfairly impacted in the time prior to and after the events described herein, creating increased urgency for action from this Court. (See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing suppression of evidence central to family welfare.)

85. This hardship is compounded by the Bar's refusal to engage, forcing Petitioner into this petition as a last resort, with no adequate compensation for the time, stress, and family suffering caused by a dispute that should have been resolved over a year ago but for the misconduct and cover-ups described herein.

D. Bad Faith and Willful Non-Compliance:

86. Respondents' actions evidence bad faith, including willful delays, strategic concealment of information/documents, and selective enforcement.

87. The Bar ignored repeated requests for engagement under the rules since February 2025, provided incomplete records, and failed to justify exemptions, suggesting an intent to shield insiders amid corruption allegations.

88. Bad faith warrants mandatory fees under § 119.12(1), Fla. Stat., where unlawful refusal occurs (even analogously for judicial records should the Court refuse expansive consideration of 119.12(1)), as courts award fees to deter such conduct and promote compliance. New Times, Inc. v. Monroe County Sheriff's Office, 245 So. 3d 740 (Fla. 3d DCA 2018). See also Bd. of Trs., Jacksonville Police & Fire Pension Fund v. Lee, 189 So. 3d 120, 125 (Fla. 2016) (holding that agencies must pay fees for unlawful withholding of public records, even absent bad faith, to encourage compliance).

E. Attorney's Fees and Costs:

89. Petitioner is entitled to attorney's fees and costs under multiple grounds, including Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for mandamus relief from denials of access to judicial records; Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and unreasonable obstruction; and common law and equity principles for

Respondents' pattern of delays, non-responses, failure/refusal to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards as exemplified in Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) (unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith) and Wood v. Marston, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983) (fee awards for bad faith conduct).

90. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12, Florida Statutes, if Chapter 119 applies, particularly given the systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit necessitating a reassessment or distinction of Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), where the requested records are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption; under equitable principles and public interest exceptions to deter future misconduct and prevent burdens on citizens enforcing constitutional guarantees, as affirmed in Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency); and independently under the Federal and Florida Constitutions for violations of Article I, Section 24 and due process rights.

91. Respondents' unlawful withholding of records and aggressive refusal to engage as required by the rules, all in bad faith, evidenced by ongoing delays since February 2025, selective omissions, and complete non-responses to recent inquiries on information that must be in the public record, further supports this entitlement.

92. Courts have recognized that mandamus actions involving transparency justify fee awards to deter future misconduct and ensure citizens are not burdened for enforcing constitutional guarantees. Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (affirming fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency).

See also Bd. of Trs. v. Lee, 189 So. 3d at 125 (mandatory fees for unlawful records withholding to promote access). VI. V. Clear Legal Duty and No Adequate Remedy

VI. Conclusion:

93. The Bar has a ministerial duty to engage with the complainant, conduct at least a preliminary investigation, and disclose public records.

94. It's failed in all of those duties as described herein and demonstrated in the appendix materials.

95. Mandamus is appropriate where, as here, administrative remedies are exhausted and no alternative exists. See Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917 (Fla. 2008). ; see also Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 813 So. 2d at 1022 (mandamus lies to compel Bar's performance of clear duties in disciplinary matters).

96. As Petitioner has made clear throughout this process, time is of the essence and timely orders on these issues are appropriate given the Bar's failure to respond or otherwise engage for several months.

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, in addition to the relief already requested, Petitioner respectfully prays this Court:

1. Declare Respondents' actions relating to the deficiencies described above violative of Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution; Rule 3-7.1; and Rule 2.420

2. Issue a writ of mandamus compelling:

· Immediate production of all requested records including but not limited to all materials sent to and/or received from Mr. Davis and/or anyone on his behalf. Specifically, this includes all communications involving Mr. Davis to or from Alicia Gangi, Allie Huston, and all other bar employees and representatives or a sworn statement confirming none exist;

· A detailed privilege log;

· Searches of personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives involved in the matter;

· A written explanation of the search process and devices searched;

3. Reopen the Davis complaint and conduct a proper investigation required by the Rules.

4. Require Mandatory engagement with Petitioner regarding the Bar's handling of the Davis complaint under Rule 3-7.3(c).

5. Appoint independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the Davis investigation and the initial mishandling of it to ensure impartiality, accountability, and public confidence.

6. Require Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to complete sworn statements explaining the failure/refusal to "engage" with Petitioner regarding the Davis bar complaint and describing any conversations with Mr. Davis and anyone else with whom the complaint and related matters were discussed. Order Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to appear for depositions should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

7. Require Mr. Courtemanche to Huston to complete a sworn statements explaining the refusal to comply with bar rules and transparency requirements with an order to appear for deposition should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

8. Order Judge Ayers to provide a sworn statement advising of any and all statements from Petitioner she believes to be untrue and dismiss the retaliatory Bar complaint against Petitioner (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)) as an abuse of process and violation of due process rights.

9. Refer the Judicial Qualifications Commission's dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Judge Ayers to the Florida Supreme Court for review and reassessment, given the systemic conflicts and lack of transparency documented herein. (Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201.)

10. Appoint another independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the investigation and handling of bar complaints (not yet filed due to concerns of bias, insider protectionism and systemic corruption in the FL Bar, but) necessary for other individuals involved in the facts discussed herein. The Bar finding the obvious misconduct in those related cases still to come would further highlight the Bar's failures in the Davis case, so an independent counsel is necessary for objectivity.

11. Find Section 119 applicable to these proceedings involving significant systemic corruption and a quasi-judicial body acting more as a state agency, making Chapter 119's requirements critical for public protection.

12. Award reasonable attorney fees and costs under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(l) for mandamus relief; Ch. 86, Fla. Stat., and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and obstruction; common law/equity for Respondents' delays, non-responses, failure to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards per Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) and Wood v. Marston, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983). Additionally and alternatively under §119.12, Fla. Stat., if Ch. 119 applies, given the agency like functions of the Florida Bar and systemic corruption requiring reassessment of Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660

So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995); under equitable/public interest principles to deter misconduct per Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004); and under the Florida Constitutions for violations of Art. I, § 24 and due process rights.

13. Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l), grant expedited review of Respondents' denial of engagement and access to Bar records, within 30 days of this filing, to prevent further irreparable harm from ongoing opacity, delays in family law proceedings, and erosion of public confidence in the judicial system, as detailed in Sections III (Factual Background) and V. C (Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm)

14. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper to ensure transparency, deter future misconduct, and restore public confidence.

15. Petitioner specifically requests a jury trial for any and all issues so triable.

Verification:

I, Christopher Hanson, on December 17, 2025, swear under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct based on my personal knowledge.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson
Christopher Alan Hanson

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees has been furnished by email to:

The Florida Bar
Attn: Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, Alicia Gangi,
651 East Jefferson Street

Tallahassee, Florida 32399-2300
rcourtemanche@floridabar.org; acapintake@floridabar.org; agangi@gunster.com

on this 17th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson
Christopher Alan Hanson
FL Bar No. 44094
[redacted]
727-409-5738
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[redacted]